

MSI Wind U210

MSI plans to launch the Wind U210 with a 1.6 GHz AMD Athlon Neo processor, a 12.1 inch HD display and ATI Mobility Radeon X1250 graphics

Samsung N510

Samsung's N510 featuring NVIDIA's Ion chipset expected to be launched next month

In the days when 160 GB has become quite common for netbooks, the MSI Wind's 80 GB hard drive space feels rather cramped. Also, the model that we received came with SuSe Linux Enterprise Desktop 10 pre-installed instead of Windows XP. Lastly, the battery life did not fare so well, clocking in at 1.5 hours. At Rs. 20,000, the MSI Wind's pricing is fair. But other than the great screen, it does not have anything special that would inspire us to recommend it. At just Rs. 1,500 more, you can get the Eee PC 1005HA that trumps this model on many counts.

Intex N101W-C1100

Tacky-designed, nothing extraordinary

- Decent web cam and battery life.
- Tacky design, no OS preinstalled.

Intex has taken a different approach in terms of design with its N101W netbook. It is designed to resemble a book; suggesting that it is targeted at the youth. Also, due to its design, the screen cannot be tilted beyond roughly 120 degrees. The build quality is quite acceptable, but this



Intex N101W-C1100

is not very thin. On the inside, we have a 1024x576 pixel display; just four vertical pixels shy of the typical 1024x600 resolution. The keyboard is good in terms of typing comfort and the direction keys are a wee bit smaller than usual. The touch-pad sensitivity is about average, although the odd button placement might not be convenient for some.

Many of us are aware that installing Windows XP (especially using a USB flash drive) is a lengthy and difficult procedure. The least Intex could do is sell the N101W with a Linux OS. After installing XP ourselves, we ran it through our battery of tests. Of them, we couldn't get Quake3 to run on this one. The same was the case with our test to judge screen brightness and contrast ratio. The battery lasted an acceptable two hours and twenty minutes. Thus we should expect around three hours of normal play-time with this model. The web cam delivered a clear image with a decent frame-rate.

At Rs. 19,000, the price seems to be quite fair. But its design philosophy and average usability does not help us recommend this model.

Conclusion

After our exhaustive testing, we come to the conclusion that the Eee PC 1005HA bags the prize as the best performer. It has the right mix of components coupled with an elegant design and a perfect price; given its functionality. Coming in close at second place is the other ASUS Eee PC 1101HA. The Sony Vaio W follows. Other than the ultra-high price tag, we found nothing to complain about this

CONNOI TABLET PC

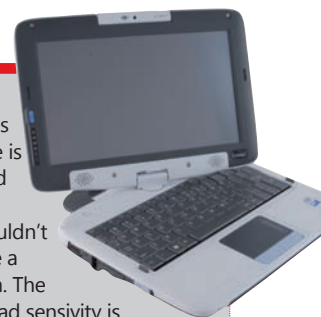
A good companion for kids

The Connoi Tablet PC is based on the Intel Classmate PC concept. As we will see further in this review, this model is specifically targeted at school-going kids. For one, this netbook looks a bit kiddish, but its plastic body is built decently. The manufacturers claim that it is sturdy enough to survive drops and water spills. It has a (removable) handle for carrying it around like a mini-briefcase. At 1.35 kg, it's not overly heavy and shouldn't add substantial weight to a kid's already-heavy school-enabled model amongst all those in this test. The screen has a 180-degree tilting mechanism that converts this typical netbook into a stylus-operated tablet. You can even use it in vertical mode like an e-book reader.

The screen is slightly small at 8.9 inches, but bears a standard 1024x600 pixel resolution. Although the screen accepts stylus input fairly well, the underlying software (and Windows XP) is not finger-optimised. Thus, kids will need to whip out the stylus or try to use their fingernails to operate this device. The keyboard under the screen is somewhat cramped for adults with large fingers. But,

since this machine is intended for kids, this shouldn't really be a problem. The touch-pad sensitivity is also good. Spec-wise there are a few differences from the rest of the herd. For one, this netbook has a 1.8-inch 60 GB hard disk; which might prove to be insufficient in today's world.

Performance-wise, it worked at a decent pace. The performance bottle-neck in this machine proved to be its slower 1.8-inch hard drive. We also hoped for a little more than 2.5 hours from its 6-cell battery. In terms of software, it comes with a number of usable apps. The best had to be ArtRage2, a touch-friendly version of a Paint app. Even the handwriting recognition tool is quite accurate, after a brief training session. At Rs. 24,500, it is priced appropriately considering that it is a netbook-cum-tablet PC. This makes it quite a sweet deal and would be a good choice as a first PC for kids. It will help them jump onto the electronic revolution at an early age.



model. If Sony slashes the price by at least Rs. 5,000 rupees, we'll be glad to recommend it.

Going by sheer numbers, the Zenith Premium Z-book takes the Best Buy Award thanks to its ultra-low Rs. 16,500 price tag. Although it has the same internals as most of the models out there, it somewhat lacks in terms of usability. We feel you should spend a few thousand rupees more to get the Eee PC 1005HA.

Another model we'd like to

highlight is the Connoi Classmate PC. This netbook is designed with the idea that computers are going to be a big part of children's education, and not just another subject in the curriculum. Its touch-screen abilities bring out many unique features that children can use. Also, this is a real PC, with a familiar operating system that provides a plethora of usability options. If you are willing to invest Rs. 25,000, this could very well be a great gift for your child. **[d]**

Contact Sheet

Brand	Contact	Phone	Email address	Web site
Connoi	Connoisseur Electronics Private limited	+91-80-4115 2203	harish@connoisseur.com	www.connoisseur.com
MSI	MSI India	+91-11-4175 8808	marketing@msi-in.com	http://in.msi.com
Intex	Intex Technologies (India) Ltd	1-800-116 789	info@intextechnologies.com	www.intextechnologies.com
Zenith	Zenith Computers Limited	1-800-222 004	info@zenith-india.com	www.zenithpc.com
ASUS	ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.	1-800-209 0365	media_india@asus.com	www.asus.in
Sony	Sony India	1-800-111 188	sonyindia.care@ap.sony.com	www.sony.co.in
Samsung	Samsung India	+91-11-4151 1234	ravi.gulati@samsung.com	samsung.co.in